

chief ministers of their respective states. For better functioning of the Government, Banerjee and Alagiri should be dropped from the Council of Ministers.
P.C. SINHA, Patna

The cover story and the editor-in-chief's illumination of the factual scorecard of the UPA II are awesome feedback to the countrymen. Though the Government has some highs to boast of—growth rate, stability, development, employment, food security, RTI and universal education—it is faced with the challenges of foreign and internal terrorism. It's high time a permanent solution to these issues was found out.

RAMESH SINHA, Delhi

Cost of Caste

Professor Dipankar Gupta's column was one of the most hard-hitting pieces I have read in recent times ("Caste Against Citizens", May 24). I'm glad that a prominent sociologist like him has had the gumption to write so frankly on an issue which has unfortunately been given prominence at this time for various reasons and with no thought given to the damage it can cause in the future.

AMBER SEN, Delhi

On the Waterfront

The Kaliya Mardana Ashram at Mulki has been

a pioneer in teaching surfing in India in the recent past ("The Surfing Swamis", May 31). Our country has vast surfing sea areas which can help it become not only a major international centre for surfing, but also help us earn billions of dollars by promoting this sport extensively.
V.K. TANGRI,
via www.indiatoday.in

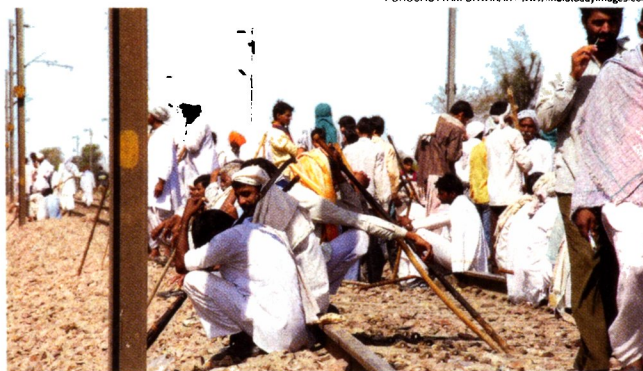
Home Learning

Most of the schools and colleges practically destroy a child's interest in learn-

conventional wisdom. Schools and colleges must instil the thirst for acquiring knowledge among children rather than force them to study.
BHUMISH KHUDKHUDIA,
Mumbai

Past Imperfect

Former vice-president B.S. Shekhawat will be remembered for his friendships across party lines, but it is too much to term his craze to become the President as his being a man of ambition ("Obituary: B.S. Shekhawat", May 31). He



“If we could not uplift the backward castes or classes in all these years, the possibilities of their amelioration may not exist after the caste-based census either (“The Caste Curse”, May 24).”

SANJIV GUPTA, Perth, Australia

ing ("The De-School Brigade", May 24). It is true that in India, the holistic evolution of the child is no longer the core purpose of education. Education is not just about scoring well in examinations, it is also about innovation, about challenging

will also be remembered for lowering the dignity of post of the vice-president when he vacated an additional government bungalow after several RTI petitions compelled the Government to initiate harsh eviction proceedings.
S.C. AGRAWAL, Delhi

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

AUGUST 16-31, 1980

Filling the Void

There is a massive question mark looming like some dark monsoon cloud over the capital's rain-soaked skies these days—who will don the mantle so rudely torn from Sanjay's shoulders? The answer is as complex as the person who inadvertently caused it to be raised. On the surface of India's political pond, the question has hardly created a ripple. But below it, there are a welter of cross-currents that have transformed Sanjay's succession issue into a high political drama. Intrigue and suspense disintegrating into bitter factionalism; palace plots and regional intrigues; the good guys versus the bad guys; the old versus the young; the ruling party, adrift from its moorings, in desperate search of a buoy; Mrs Gandhi, aloof and imperious, maintaining a deafening silence on the subject; and, wandering like Hamlet's ghost through the entire plot, the all-pervasive memory of Sanjay Gandhi and all that he stood for.

by Prabhu Chawla and Dilip Bobb



MRS GANDHI WITH HER FAMILY

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